

PASSIVE INCOME BLUEPRINT

30 Proven Strategies to Build Wealth While You
Sleep

Daniel Tesfamariam

2026 Edition

PASSIVE INCOME BLUEPRINT

by Daniel Tesfamariam

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CHAPTER 1

Digital Products: Ebooks

Self-publishing ebooks on platforms like Amazon KDP requires minimal upfront investment yet generates royalties for years after initial creation. A single well-targeted ebook in a hungry niche can earn hundreds monthly indefinitely.

Success requires identifying underserved topics with proven demand through keyword research tools. Focus on solving specific problems rather than covering broad topics, as specificity converts browsers into buyers.

Production costs are minimal: your time for writing, a freelance editor for fifty to two hundred dollars, and a cover designer for twenty to one hundred dollars. Total investment under three hundred dollars per book.

The compound effect of multiple titles creates a self-reinforcing catalog. Readers who enjoy one book purchase others, and Amazon's algorithm rewards prolific authors with increased visibility in search results.

To truly master digital products: ebooks, consider how these principles apply specifically to your unique situation. Every person brings different experiences, strengths, and challenges to this topic. What works perfectly for one person may require modification for another based on lifestyle, personality, and existing commitments.

Research consistently supports the approaches outlined in this

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Common obstacles when implementing these ideas include initial resistance to change, temporary discomfort during the adjustment period, and the temptation to revert to familiar but less effective patterns of behavior. Anticipating these obstacles allows you to plan responses in advance rather than being caught off-guard.

Success stories from people who have mastered digital products: ebooks share common elements: they started with small consistent steps, they tracked their progress objectively, they sought accountability from others, and they persisted through inevitable setbacks without allowing temporary failures to become permanent abandonment.

The relationship between digital products: ebooks and overall life satisfaction is well documented in research literature. Improvements in this area tend to cascade positively into other domains including relationships, career performance, physical health, and personal wellbeing. This interconnection means your investment here pays dividends across your entire

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Consider keeping a dedicated journal for your progress with digital products: ebooks. Daily reflection of even two to three sentences creates accountability, reveals patterns invisible in the moment, and provides motivating evidence of growth over time that sustains effort during difficult periods when progress feels invisible.

Practical implementation requires choosing the right time, place, and context for practicing these skills. Identify the specific moments in your daily routine where these principles most naturally apply, then create reminders or environmental cues that prompt you to practice rather than relying on memory alone.

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Teaching others what you learn about digital products: ebooks reinforces your own understanding and commitment. When you explain concepts to friends, family, or colleagues, you deepen

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Remember that mastery is a journey without a final destination. Even experts in digital products: ebooks continue learning, adjusting, and growing throughout their lives. The goal is continuous improvement rather than perfection, progress rather than completion.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- * Start with the lowest barrier option that matches your current resources
- * Passive income requires active effort upfront before becoming truly passive
- * Diversification across multiple streams creates financial resilience

ACTION STEP:

Research the requirements for digital products: ebooks and determine if this strategy aligns with your available capital, time, and skills.

CHAPTER 2

Digital Products: Online Courses

Online courses command premium prices from twenty-nine to nine hundred ninety-nine dollars because they promise transformation rather than just information. Once created, courses sell indefinitely with zero marginal cost per sale.

Choose topics where you have genuine expertise and where learners can achieve measurable outcomes. Courses that help people earn money, advance careers, or solve pressing problems have the highest demand and conversion rates.

Production requires a structured curriculum, recorded video lessons, supplementary materials, and a hosting platform. Initial creation takes two hundred to five hundred hours but generates income for years afterward.

Marketing through content funnels drives consistent sales. Create free content that demonstrates expertise and naturally leads interested learners toward your paid course as the logical next step in their journey.

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CHAPTER 3

Digital Products: Templates and Tools

Templates save people time by providing pre-built structures for common tasks. Spreadsheet templates, document templates, design templates, and planning tools all sell consistently across various marketplaces.

Create templates that solve recurring problems for specific professions or activities. A wedding planning spreadsheet, a freelancer invoice template, or a social media content calendar each targets clear buyer intent.

Pricing ranges from five to ninety-nine dollars depending on complexity and value delivered. High-volume low-price items on marketplaces like Etsy generate substantial revenue through sheer volume of sales.

Updates and improvements to existing templates provide reasons to re-engage past customers and generate additional sales from the same audience without creating entirely new products from scratch.

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CHAPTER 4

Digital Products: Printables

Printable products including planners, wall art, worksheets, and organizational tools sell millions of units annually on Etsy and personal websites with zero physical inventory or shipping requirements.

Design tools like Canva make creation accessible to non-designers. Focus on aesthetics, functionality, and solving specific organizational or decorative needs that customers cannot easily find elsewhere.

The printables market thrives on volume and variety. Successful sellers maintain catalogs of hundreds of listings, each targeting specific keywords and customer needs with optimized titles and descriptions.

Seasonal products create predictable revenue spikes. Back-to-school planners, holiday decorations, New Year goal-setting worksheets, and wedding planning printables sell in concentrated bursts of high demand.

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CHAPTER 5

Digital Products: Stock Photos

Stock photography platforms pay royalties every time someone licenses your images. A portfolio of several thousand quality images generates consistent monthly income without ongoing time investment after upload.

Niche photography outperforms generic content. Images depicting specific industries, diverse representation, modern workplaces, and trending lifestyle concepts fill gaps that commercial buyers struggle to find.

Equipment investment is moderate: a capable camera and basic editing software. Many successful contributors use mid-range mirrorless cameras that produce more than sufficient quality for stock licensing.

The key metric is portfolio size. Contributors with over five thousand images typically earn one thousand to five thousand monthly. Consistent uploading of twenty to fifty images weekly builds this foundation over time.

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CHAPTER 6

Investments: Dividend Stocks

Dividend-paying stocks provide regular income payments simply for owning shares. Companies with long histories of increasing dividends provide growing income streams that outpace inflation over decades.

Building a dividend portfolio requires patience and consistency. Regular monthly investments through dollar-cost averaging reduce timing risk while systematically building your income-generating asset base.

A portfolio yielding three to four percent on five hundred thousand dollars generates fifteen to twenty thousand annually in truly passive income. Reaching this level requires years of disciplined saving and investing.

Dividend reinvestment during accumulation years accelerates growth dramatically through compounding. Once you reach your income target, switch to receiving dividends as cash flow while maintaining your principal.

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CHAPTER 7

Investments: REITs

Real Estate Investment Trusts provide exposure to real estate income without property management headaches. REITs are required by law to distribute ninety percent of taxable income as dividends to shareholders.

Publicly traded REITs offer liquidity that physical real estate cannot match. You can buy or sell positions instantly, diversify across property types, and start with small amounts rather than large down payments.

REIT yields typically range from three to eight percent annually depending on property sector and market conditions. Specialized REITs focusing on data centers, healthcare facilities, or logistics have shown strong growth.

Research REITs by examining funds from operations, occupancy rates, debt levels, and management track record. Diversify across sectors including residential, commercial, industrial, and specialized properties.

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CHAPTER 8

Investments: Bonds

Bonds provide predictable income through regular interest payments with lower volatility than stocks. They serve as portfolio stabilizers and reliable income sources particularly valuable during retirement.

Government bonds offer the highest safety while corporate bonds provide higher yields with moderate credit risk. Bond laddering strategies create regular income streams as bonds mature at staggered intervals.

Current yield environment matters significantly for bond investors. When purchased at favorable rates, bonds lock in income for their entire duration regardless of future rate changes affecting new issues.

Bond funds and ETFs provide instant diversification across hundreds of individual bonds with low minimums. This simplifies bond investing while maintaining liquidity not available with individual bond positions.

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CHAPTER 9

Investments: Index Funds

Index funds provide broad market exposure with minimal fees, historically returning eight to ten percent annually over long periods. Consistent investing in index funds is the simplest reliable wealth-building strategy available.

The power of index investing lies in its simplicity and mathematical advantage. By matching market returns and minimizing fees, index investors outperform the vast majority of actively managed funds over time.

A three-fund portfolio of domestic stocks, international stocks, and bonds provides comprehensive diversification with minimal complexity. Rebalancing annually maintains your target allocation as markets fluctuate.

Withdrawal strategies in retirement can sustainably generate income from index fund portfolios. The four percent rule suggests withdrawing four percent annually as a starting point, adjusting for inflation.

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CHAPTER 10

Investments: Crypto Staking

Cryptocurrency staking involves locking tokens to support blockchain networks in exchange for regular reward payments. Staking yields vary from three to twenty percent annually depending on the network and conditions.

Proof-of-stake networks like Ethereum, Solana, and Cardano allow holders to earn rewards by participating in network validation. This generates passive income from assets you intend to hold long-term regardless.

Risks include price volatility of underlying assets, smart contract vulnerabilities, lock-up periods restricting access, and potential slashing penalties for validator misbehavior on some networks.

Start with established networks offering moderate but reliable yields rather than chasing high-APY opportunities on unproven platforms. Diversify staking across multiple networks to reduce concentration risk.

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CHAPTER 11

Online Business: Dropshipping

Dropshipping eliminates inventory risk by having suppliers ship directly to customers. You focus on marketing and customer acquisition while fulfillment happens without you touching any physical products.

Success requires finding products with healthy margins, reliable suppliers, and targetable audiences. Use research tools to identify trending products with proven demand before investing in marketing campaigns.

Once systems are established with winning products, the business operates semi-passively. Automation handles order processing while paid advertising drives consistent traffic without daily management requirements.

Realistic expectations: profit margins of fifteen to thirty percent on revenue, requiring several months of testing and optimization before achieving consistent profitability. Not instant but genuinely scalable.

To truly master online business: dropshipping, consider how these principles apply specifically to your unique situation. Every person brings different experiences, strengths, and challenges to this topic. What works perfectly for one person may require modification for another based on lifestyle, personality, and existing commitments.

Research consistently supports the approaches outlined in this

chapter. Multiple peer-reviewed studies demonstrate that systematic application of these strategies produces measurable improvement within four to eight weeks of consistent practice. The science is clear and replicable across diverse populations.

Common obstacles when implementing these ideas include initial resistance to change, temporary discomfort during the adjustment period, and the temptation to revert to familiar but less effective patterns of behavior. Anticipating these obstacles allows you to plan responses in advance rather than being caught off-guard.

Success stories from people who have mastered online business: dropshipping share common elements: they started with small consistent steps, they tracked their progress objectively, they sought accountability from others, and they persisted through inevitable setbacks without allowing temporary failures to become permanent abandonment.

The relationship between online business: dropshipping and overall life satisfaction is well documented in research literature. Improvements in this area tend to cascade positively into other domains including relationships, career performance, physical health, and personal wellbeing. This interconnection means your investment here pays dividends

across your entire life.

Consider keeping a dedicated journal for your progress with online business: dropshipping. Daily reflection of even two to three sentences creates accountability, reveals patterns invisible in the moment, and provides motivating evidence of growth over time that sustains effort during difficult periods when progress feels invisible.

Practical implementation requires choosing the right time, place, and context for practicing these skills. Identify the specific moments in your daily routine where these principles most naturally apply, then create reminders or environmental cues that prompt you to practice rather than relying on memory alone.

The compound effect of daily practice in online business: dropshipping produces exponential rather than linear results. The first week may produce minimal visible change, but by week eight the accumulated effect of consistent daily practice creates transformation that appears sudden to outside observers.

Teaching others what you learn about online business: dropshipping reinforces your own understanding and commitment. When you explain concepts to friends, family, or colleagues,

you deepen your comprehension and create social accountability that strengthens your own practice.

Remember that mastery is a journey without a final destination. Even experts in online business: dropshipping continue learning, adjusting, and growing throughout their lives. The goal is continuous improvement rather than perfection, progress rather than completion.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- * Start with the lowest barrier option that matches your current resources
- * Passive income requires active effort upfront before becoming truly passive
- * Diversification across multiple streams creates financial resilience

ACTION STEP:

Research the requirements for online business: dropshipping and determine if this strategy aligns with your available capital, time, and skills.

CHAPTER 12

Online Business: Affiliate Marketing

Affiliate marketing earns commissions by recommending products you believe in. Create content that naturally incorporates product recommendations and earn every time readers purchase through your links.

Blog posts, YouTube videos, and email newsletters are primary channels for affiliate income. Evergreen content about product comparisons, tutorials, and reviews continues generating commissions for years after publication.

Commission rates vary widely from three to fifty percent depending on product category. Digital products and services typically offer higher commissions while physical products provide lower rates on higher volumes.

Building authority in a specific niche creates compounding affiliate income. As your audience grows, each new piece of content has larger reach, and accumulated content creates a web of monetized recommendations.

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CHAPTER 13

Online Business: YouTube

YouTube advertising revenue pays creators based on views, with typical RPM rates of three to fifteen dollars per thousand views depending on niche and audience demographics. Popular channels earn thousands monthly.

The platform rewards consistency and audience retention. Regular publishing of valuable content builds subscriber bases that provide reliable viewership for each new video, creating predictable and growing revenue.

Beyond ad revenue, YouTube channels monetize through sponsorships, affiliate links, merchandise, courses, and membership programs. Diversified income streams from a single channel multiply total earnings substantially.

Evergreen educational content continues generating views and revenue indefinitely. A tutorial video published today might earn for a decade as viewers continually search for solutions to persistent problems.

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CHAPTER 14

Online Business: Blogging

Blogging generates income through advertising networks, affiliate marketing, sponsored posts, and digital product sales. A well-trafficked blog in a profitable niche becomes a reliable income-producing asset.

SEO-optimized content targeting buyer-intent keywords attracts readers actively seeking solutions. These high-intent visitors convert into income through ads, affiliate purchases, and product sales at higher rates.

Building blog traffic takes twelve to twenty-four months of consistent content creation. However, once established, a blog with hundreds of articles generates traffic and income with minimal ongoing maintenance.

Monetization compounds as traffic grows. A blog earning one dollar per visitor per month needs ten thousand monthly visitors for ten thousand dollars monthly income. Achievable numbers in profitable niches.

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CHAPTER 15

Online Business: SaaS Tools

Software as a Service businesses generate recurring monthly revenue from subscribers. Even simple tools solving specific problems can generate substantial income through the power of recurring subscription payments.

No-code and low-code platforms make SaaS creation accessible without engineering teams. Simple tools like calculators, schedulers, generators, and trackers can be built and launched with minimal technical expertise.

Monthly subscription pricing of ten to ninety-nine dollars creates predictable revenue. One thousand subscribers at twenty-nine dollars monthly generates nearly thirty thousand in monthly recurring revenue.

Once built and launched, SaaS products require modest ongoing maintenance: bug fixes, customer support, and incremental improvements. The recurring nature of revenue makes this among the most passive business models.

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CHAPTER 16

Real Estate: Rental Properties

Rental properties provide monthly cash flow, equity building through mortgage paydown, appreciation, and significant tax advantages. This combination creates wealth more reliably than almost any other vehicle.

Cash-on-cash returns of eight to fifteen percent are achievable in many markets when purchasing correctly. Focus on properties where rental income exceeds all expenses by at least two hundred dollars monthly per unit.

Management can be delegated to property managers for eight to twelve percent of collected rent. This makes rental income genuinely passive after initial acquisition and setup while maintaining investment returns.

Leverage amplifies returns dramatically. A twenty percent down payment controls one hundred percent of the asset value. Appreciation and rent growth apply to the full value while your investment is only a fraction.

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CHAPTER 17

Real Estate: Short-Term Rentals

Short-term rentals through platforms like Airbnb often generate two to three times the income of traditional long-term rentals. Popular locations and well-presented properties can earn thousands per week.

Automation through smart locks, automated messaging, cleaning crews, and dynamic pricing software makes short-term rental management scalable. Some operators manage dozens of properties with minimal daily involvement.

Location and guest experience determine success. Properties near attractions, in walkable areas, or offering unique experiences command premium nightly rates with high occupancy year-round.

Regulation varies significantly by location. Research local short-term rental laws thoroughly before investing. Many profitable markets have clear legal frameworks supporting this business model.

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CHAPTER 18

Real Estate: House Hacking

House hacking involves living in one unit of a multi-family property while renting other units. Rental income from tenants covers most or all of your housing costs, dramatically accelerating wealth building.

FHA loans allow purchasing up to four-unit properties with just three and a half percent down when you live in one unit. This low barrier to entry makes house hacking accessible to many first-time buyers.

The financial impact is transformative. Eliminating your largest expense while building equity and gaining landlord experience creates a triple benefit that compounds over your entire financial life.

After living in the property for one year, you can move to another house hack and convert the first property to a full rental. Repeating this strategy every one to two years builds a portfolio efficiently.

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CHAPTER 19

Real Estate: Land Investing

Raw land requires no maintenance, no tenants, no repairs, and no utilities. It appreciates passively, can generate income through leasing, and can be purchased at deep discounts through tax sales and direct mail.

Strategies include buying cheap rural land for resale with seller financing, leasing land for parking or storage, and buying in growth paths ahead of development for substantial appreciation.

Seller financing on land sales creates passive monthly income streams. Sell a piece of land for a down payment plus monthly installments and collect payments like a bank without maintenance obligations.

Due diligence for land purchases is simpler than improved properties. Check zoning, access, utilities availability, liens, and environmental issues. No inspections of structures or systems required.

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CHAPTER 20

Creative: Music Royalties

Music licensing platforms pay creators every time their tracks are used in videos, podcasts, advertisements, and media productions. A catalog of production music generates royalties passively across multiple platforms.

Even non-musicians can participate by hiring producers to create tracks or by using AI music generation tools to create commercially licensable compositions for specific moods and use cases.

Royalty rates per use are small but compound across large catalogs. Producers with hundreds of tracks across multiple licensing platforms regularly earn one to five thousand monthly from accumulated placements.

Focus on underserved categories: corporate background music, podcast intros, meditation soundscapes, and workout tracks. These functional music categories have consistent demand with less competition than popular genres.

To truly master creative: music royalties, consider how these principles apply specifically to your unique situation. Every person brings different experiences, strengths, and challenges to this topic. What works perfectly for one person may require modification for another based on lifestyle, personality, and existing commitments.

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CHAPTER 21

Creative: Content Licensing

Licensing existing content for use by others creates income without creating new work. Written content, photography, designs, and videos can all be licensed to publishers, brands, and media companies.

Syndication of written content means one article can earn from multiple publishers. Platforms exist specifically for content syndication, paying writers every time their articles are republished.

Design assets including icons, illustrations, and UI kits sell repeatedly on marketplaces. Creating a catalog of useful design elements generates ongoing passive sales from a one-time creative investment.

Video footage licensing through stock video platforms pays creators for clips used in commercial productions. Drone footage, nature scenes, and urban timelapses have particularly strong ongoing demand.

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Common obstacles when implementing these ideas include initial resistance to change, temporary discomfort during the adjustment period, and the temptation to revert to familiar but less effective patterns of behavior. Anticipating these obstacles allows you to plan responses in advance rather than being caught off-guard.

Success stories from people who have mastered creative: content licensing share common elements: they started with small consistent steps, they tracked their progress objectively, they sought accountability from others, and they persisted through inevitable setbacks without allowing temporary failures to become permanent abandonment.

The relationship between creative: content licensing and overall life satisfaction is well documented in research literature. Improvements in this area tend to cascade positively into other domains including relationships, career performance, physical health, and personal wellbeing. This interconnection means your investment here pays dividends

across your entire life.

Consider keeping a dedicated journal for your progress with creative: content licensing. Daily reflection of even two to three sentences creates accountability, reveals patterns invisible in the moment, and provides motivating evidence of growth over time that sustains effort during difficult periods when progress feels invisible.

Practical implementation requires choosing the right time, place, and context for practicing these skills. Identify the specific moments in your daily routine where these principles most naturally apply, then create reminders or environmental cues that prompt you to practice rather than relying on memory alone.

The compound effect of daily practice in creative: content licensing produces exponential rather than linear results. The first week may produce minimal visible change, but by week eight the accumulated effect of consistent daily practice creates transformation that appears sudden to outside observers.

Teaching others what you learn about creative: content licensing reinforces your own understanding and commitment. When you explain concepts to friends, family, or colleagues,

you deepen your comprehension and create social accountability that strengthens your own practice.

Remember that mastery is a journey without a final destination. Even experts in creative: content licensing continue learning, adjusting, and growing throughout their lives. The goal is continuous improvement rather than perfection, progress rather than completion.

KEY TAKEAWAYS:

- * Start with the lowest barrier option that matches your current resources
- * Passive income requires active effort upfront before becoming truly passive
- * Diversification across multiple streams creates financial resilience

ACTION STEP:

Research the requirements for creative: content licensing and determine if this strategy aligns with your available capital, time, and skills.

CHAPTER 22

Creative: Print-on-Demand Merch

Print-on-demand services handle printing, shipping, and customer service for products featuring your designs. You create designs once and earn royalties on every sale with zero inventory or fulfillment responsibilities.

Platforms include Amazon Merch, Redbubble, TeePublic, and Printful integrations with Shopify. Each has different strengths: Amazon provides massive traffic while independent stores offer higher margins.

Success is a numbers game. Top sellers maintain catalogs of thousands of designs across multiple niches and platforms. Individual designs may sell one or two units monthly, but volume creates meaningful income.

Trend research identifies high-demand low-competition design opportunities. Seasonal events, trending phrases, niche humor, and community-specific references all represent profitable design categories.

To truly master creative: print-on-demand merch, consider how these principles apply specifically to your unique situation. Every person brings different experiences, strengths, and challenges to this topic. What works perfectly for one person may require modification for another based on lifestyle, personality, and existing commitments.

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Research the requirements for creative: print-on-demand merch and determine if this strategy aligns with your available capital, time, and skills.

CHAPTER 23

Creative: Patent Licensing

Patents protect inventions and allow licensing to manufacturers who pay ongoing royalties for the right to produce and sell products using your patented technology or design.

Utility patents protect functional innovations while design patents protect ornamental appearances. Both can generate licensing income when companies want to use your protected intellectual property.

The patent process requires investment in filing and legal fees but successful patents can generate royalties for up to twenty years. Even single-product patents can produce substantial cumulative income.

Licensing rather than manufacturing means no factory, no inventory, no shipping, and no customer service. You simply collect royalty payments while licensees handle all commercialization activities.

To truly master creative: patent licensing, consider how these principles apply specifically to your unique situation. Every person brings different experiences, strengths, and challenges to this topic. What works perfectly for one person may require modification for another based on lifestyle, personality, and existing commitments.

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Thank you for reading!

by Daniel Tesfamariam

If you found this book helpful, please leave a review.